

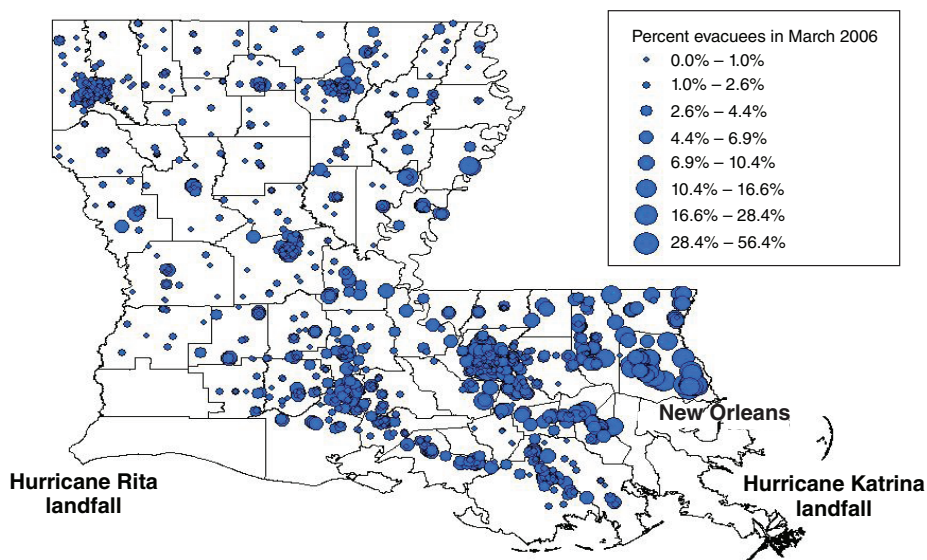


FIGURE 2. HURRICANES KATRINA AND RITA EVACUEES IN LOUISIANA BY SCHOOL, 2005–2006

Notes: Map shows Katrina and Rita evacuees as of March 2006 Louisiana Educational Assessment Program (LEAP) testing. Schools with more than 70 percent evacuees and those in Cameron and Calcasieu Parishes (Rita landfall area) and Orleans, St. Bernard, Plaquemines, and Jefferson Parishes (Katrina landfall area) are excluded as these schools were likely directly affected by the storms.

in these two maps. Instead, we control for past student performance and school effects so that we account for the possibility that evacuees may be concentrated in certain neighborhoods and potentially in schools with students of different quality. Moreover, we exploit the influx of evacuees in different grades. This means that our identification is coming from the exogeneity of the inflow of evacuees in various grades to changes in school characteristics. Below, we provide empirical support for this assumption.

B. School Responses

While receiving districts made great efforts to accommodate the new students, many parents worried about financial burdens and overcrowding. Indeed, a superintendent in Baton Rouge described this time to us as a “very chaotic time ... with everything changing from day to day.” Having sufficient resources was a concern for many schools. For example, one news report said that HISD would face an extra \$20 million in costs over the 2005–2006 school year (Klein 2006). Districts were eligible for grants via the McKinney-Vento Act, however, and in 2005 Congress passed legislation to aid school districts with evacuees. This assistance ultimately amounted to \$6,000 per student (Radcliffe 2006). This, combined with temporary exemptions of evacuees from counting toward accountability requirements in Texas, ensured that schools were careful to correctly identify the evacuees in their records.¹¹

¹¹ In Texas, evacuee performance was excluded from accountability calculations for all schools in 2005–2006, but was included starting in 2006–2007. Louisiana exempted all schools from accountability in 2005–2006.